

■ Pattern

$s:obj$ represents the pattern object obj , assigned the name s .

The name s must be a symbol. ■ The object obj can be any pattern object. ■ When a transformation rule is used, any occurrence of s on the right-hand side is replaced by whatever expression it matched on the left-hand side. ■ The operator $:$ has a comparatively low precedence. The expression $x:_{+}$ is thus interpreted as $x:(_{+})$, not $(x:_{+})$. ■ The form s_{-} is equivalent to $s:_{-}$. Similarly, $s_{-}h$ is equivalent to $s:_{-}h$, s_{-}_{-} to $s:_{-}_{-}$, and so on. ■ See page 557.